Student interview and suitability record: Years 3 and 4

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 8 minutes in Year 3 and 12 minutes in Year 4, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**, as a friendly chat. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, school, friends, **hopes for the future**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. In Year 3 the sentence reading is done with the Early Reading Screen; in Year 4 the interview opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 3; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Sit beside the child. Have paper and crayons ready: some children talk more easily while drawing ("Draw something you love doing, and tell me about it"). Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, a choice, or pointing). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the child cannot answer in English, one or two answers may be given in Chinese: mark them "C" and do not count them towards the speaking band.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (Year 4, 3 to 4 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___

2. Questions

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me about you.	What is your name? How old are you?	What makes you special?	
	Who is in your family?	Do you have a brother or sister? A pet?	What do you like doing with your family?	
School	Tell me about your school.	Do you like school?	What is the best thing about it?	
	What is your favourite thing to learn? Why?	Do you like maths? Reading? Art?	What did you learn last week?	
	What is hard for you at school? What do you do?	Is anything hard?	Who helps you?	
	Do you read at home? Tell me about a book you like.	Do you like stories?	What happened in it?	
Things I like	What do you like to do after school?	Do you like to play outside? Draw? Sport?	What are you best at?	
	Do you have classes after school or at the weekend?	Do you go to classes on Saturday?	Do you like them?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend? What is their name?	What do you play together?	
	What makes you happy? What makes you sad?	Are you happy today?	What do you do when you are sad?	
	How do you feel about a new school?	Happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you?	
When I grow up	What do you want to be when you grow up?	Do you want to be a teacher? A doctor? Something else?	Why?	
	What would you like to learn at our school?	Do you want to learn English? Sport? Music?		
Kindness	A child in your class is crying. What do you do?	Do you help them?	How can you help?	
Questions for us	Do you want to ask me anything?			

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best, for a child of this age.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	No English yet, or a few single words ("yes", "cat"). Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. Understands very little without pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Single words, short phrases and some simple sentences ("I like football"). Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions with support.
C Developing competence	Answers in short sentences and can say a little more with prompting ("I like football because it is fun"). Errors are common; meaning is usually clear.
D Competent	Talks easily, joins ideas, tells a little story or explains, with occasional errors. Understands nearly everything said at a normal pace.
E Fluent	Speaks as a fluent English-speaking child of the same age would.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility:

4. Suitability

Rate each strand. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning	Has a go, enjoys success, tries again after a mistake	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Interested in the activities and pictures, asks questions	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Separates from the parent and settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence	Follows two-step instructions, manages pencils and paper, can work alone for a few minutes	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Kindness and conduct	Polite, shares, gives a kind answer to the kindness question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for learning in English	Happy to try English words, copies new words, not upset by not understanding	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example speech and language, attention, hearing, vision, fine motor skills, pencil grip)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example very anxious, tired, very heavy after-school workload)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a quiet space).

Interviewer signature and date _____